> In anticipation of your kind permission, I have included your name in the list of Legal Advisers. It is true as you say that the great distance between Tuticorin and Salem would militate against our frequently availing ourselves of your valued counsel but our object in inserting your name is, apart from the matter of receiving legal advice, to give our company a locus standi. Names of well-known patriots like you would be a good inducement for people to join.
>
> Owing to shortness of time for registration I took the liberty of inserting your name even before receiving your reply. I hope you will excuse it.[37]

Deferring to the addressee's age and accomplishments—for Vijayaraghavachari (Figure 3) was a legal luminary, public figure of all-India standing (the future president of the Indian National Congress, in 1920)—VOC signed it off as 'yours obediently'. From the tone and content of the letter it is abundantly clear that VOC had decisive power in the company and commanded enough respect outside as well to include highly regarded names even without their prior consent. As we shall see, though he was included primarily to enhance the prestige of the company, Vijayaraghavachari played an important role in the company until the very last despite his age and initial hesitation. VOC had undoubtedly netted a big fish.